

Monday, 25 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Clear

34° 22°

BIRMINGHAM

Clear

33° 19°

MANCHESTER

Clear

32° 17°

GLASGOW

Overcast

23° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

A former Green Party by-election candidate has apologised after sharing a "false flag" post online.

Chris Kennedy, who recently withdrew from a by-election, shared content suggesting a shooting was a staged event. The party has since distanced itself from his controversial remarks.

POLITICS · UK

2

A former Labour minister has criticised the amount spent on benefits compared to jobs for young people.

Alan Milburn describes it as "shameful," arguing that welfare system reforms are needed. He believes this would help get more young people into work or education.

SOCIAL POLICY · UK

3

Tributes are being paid to a "brave and strong" British man who was killed while serving in Ukraine.

Ayrton Redfearn, who was 23, died on May 9th after joining a unit supporting the Ukrainian army. His family and friends have shared heartfelt messages honouring his memory.

CONFLICT · UK

What's coming up

1 **Siblings from Manchester are sharing their experiences as viewers catch up with their adventure on Race Across the World.**

Katie and Harrison entered the BBC show looking for an adventure, which viewers can now follow along with. They've described the process of reliving their journey on screen as a "weird experience."

TV · THIS WEEK

2 **Noughties girl group Mis-Teeq have confirmed they are reuniting, promising to come back "strong!"**

The group, known for hits like Scandalous and One Night Stand, blended R&B melodies with UK garage. Fans will be eager to hear what they have planned next.

MUSIC · SOON

3 **Actress Lupita Nyong'o is speaking out about her upcoming role as Helen of Troy, responding to recent criticism.**

Some critics, including Elon Musk, have questioned casting a black actress as the ancient Greek figure. Nyong'o is standing by her performance in the role, which promises a fresh take on the classic story.

THEATRE · UPCOMING

On the schedule

- 1 British driver George Russell has secured pole position "out of nowhere" at the Canadian Grand Prix.**
Russell just edged out Mercedes team-mate Kimi Antonelli in a thrilling qualifying session. It sets him up nicely for a strong performance in tomorrow's race.
F1 · CANADA
- 2 Sophie Devine starred as New Zealand recovered from a tough start to beat England in the second T20 international.**
Devine hit 87 runs off just 57 balls, helping her team to a total of 170-5 after being 11-4. This victory levels the series at 1-1, with one match left to play.
CRICKET · UK
- 3 Pep Guardiola's unique approach to football is being celebrated as he stands apart among the sport's greatest managers.**
Spanish football expert Guillem Balague explores why the Manchester City boss is considered an architect who redefined the game. His tactical genius continues to inspire debate and admiration.
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The 'silver gamer' is the fastest-growing demographic in UK gaming — over-65s spent £180 million on games last year.**
Cosy life-sim titles like Stardew Valley and Animal Crossing dominate. Console makers are reportedly designing larger UI for the market.
- 2 More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**
The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension shows up in resignation rates, particularly for under-35s.
- 3 Roses are out, peonies are in — UK florists report a 200% rise in peony orders for weddings this summer.**
Brides cite 'softer, less staged' aesthetics. Wholesale peony prices have crept up accordingly.
- 4 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.
- 5 Loneliness is now considered a bigger health risk than smoking 15 cigarettes a day, according to NHS England.**
Social prescribing — GPs referring patients to community activities — is rolling out nationwide. Walking groups, book clubs and choirs are reportedly oversubscribed.
- 6 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 7 Almost two thirds of us say we've cried at a podcast in the last year — grief, parenting and identity top the list of triggers.**
Researchers reckon it's the intimacy of audio that does it. The figure is even higher for under-30s, 71% of whom admit a recent podcast-induced tear.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 48% of us do **THIS** every single day. What is it?
ANSWER: STEP ON THE BATHROOM SCALES.

Q 63% of us have done **THIS** in a meeting we're meant to be paying attention to. What?
ANSWER: ONLINE SHOPPING.

TALK TOPIC

- **Researchers say the most stressful day to drive in the UK isn't Monday — it's THIS day.**
(Spoiler: it's Thursday.) Talk-back: what day of the week feels longest to you, and why?
- **The 'big shop' is dying — younger Brits are doing 4–6 small shops a week instead.**
Talk-back: are you a one-big-shop person or a daily-corner-shop person? And which one is your partner?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Food.** The UK's bestselling biscuit in 2025 wasn't the Custard Cream or the Hobnob — it was the humble digestive, selling over 70 million packs.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Bristol bakery has started selling 'controversial' jam doughnuts injected with mustard instead of jam, claiming a 'small but loyal' customer base.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The colour orange is named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- More people speak English in China than in the United States.
- Cleopatra lived closer in time to the moon landing than to the building of the Great Pyramid.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second.
- Goats have rectangular pupils, which gives them nearly 360-degree vision.
- Lightning strikes Earth about 100 times every second.
- Bees have to visit roughly 2 million flowers to make one pound of honey.
- Mosquitoes are attracted to people who've just eaten bananas.

On this day

Day 145 of the year, 220 days left in 2026. Today Africa Day (African Union); African Liberation Day (African Union, Rastafari); Christian feast day: Aldhelm; Christian feast day: Bede. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1976 — Cillian Murphy, Irish actor
- 1970 — Robert Croft, Welsh-English cricketer and sportscaster
- 2001 — Chloé Lukasiak, American actress and dancer
- 1944 — Charlie Harper, English singer-songwriter and producer
- 1954 — John Beck, English footballer and manager
- 1970 — Octavia Spencer, American actress and author[a]
- 1963 — Mike Myers, Canadian-American actor, singer, producer, and screenwriter
- 1959 — Julian Clary, English comedian, actor, and author

THE DAY TODAY

- 2011 — Oprah Winfrey airs her last show, ending her 25-year run of The Oprah Winfrey Show.
- 1973 — In protest against the dictatorship in Greece, the captain and crew on Greek naval destroyer Velos mutiny and refuse to return to Greece, instead anchoring at Fiumicino, Italy.
- 2000 — Liberation Day of Lebanon: Israel withdraws its army from Lebanese territory (with the exception of the disputed Shebaa farms zone) 18 years after the invasion of 1982.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1895 — The Republic of Formosa is formed, with Tang Jingsong as its president.
- 1955 — First ascent of Mount Kangchenjunga: On the British Kangchenjunga expedition led by Charles Evans, Joe Brown and George Band reach the summit of the third-highest mountain in the world (8,586 meters); Norman Hardie and Tony Streatheer join them the following day.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1966 — Explorer program: Explorer 32 launches.
- 2000 — Liberation Day of Lebanon: Israel withdraws its army from Lebanese territory (with the exception of the disputed Shebaa farms zone) 18 years after the invasion of 1982.

- 2009 — North Korea allegedly tests its second nuclear device, after which Pyongyang also conducts several missile tests, building tensions in the international community.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 146 of the year, 219 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Andrew Kaggwa; Christian feast day: Augustine of Canterbury (Anglican Communion and Eastern Orthodox); Christian feast day: Lambert of Vence; Christian feast day: Mariana de Jesús de Paredes. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1962 — Black, English singer-songwriter (died 2016)
- 1940 — Levon Helm, American singer-songwriter, drummer, producer, and actor (died 2012)
- 1926 — Miles Davis, American trumpet player, composer, and bandleader (died 1991)
- 1954 — Alan Hollinghurst, English novelist, poet, short story writer, and translator
- 1949 — Philip Michael Thomas, American actor
- 1981 — Jason Manford, English actor, screenwriter, and television host
- 1975 — Lauryn Hill, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1966 — Helena Bonham Carter, English actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1948 — The U.S. Congress passes Public Law 80-557, which permanently establishes the Civil Air Patrol as an auxiliary of the United States Air Force.
- 1981 — An EA-6B Prowler crashes on the flight deck of the aircraft carrier USS Nimitz, killing 14 crewmen and injuring 45 others.
- 1972 — Cold War: The United States and the Soviet Union sign the Anti-Ballistic Missile Treaty.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1967 — The Beatles' album Sgt. Pepper's Lonely Hearts Club Band is released.
- 1991 — Lauda Air Flight 004 breaks apart in mid-air and crashes in the Phu Toei National Park in the Suphan Buri province of Thailand, killing all 223 people on board.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026

FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)

JUNE 2026

FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026

WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		